

MGTP 424. Professional Communications for Accountants, Fall 2026

Room XXXXX Section ID XXXXX: 9:00-11:50am / Section ID XXXXX: 1:00-3:50pm

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DESCRIPTION

Oral communication is a critical part of organizational life and your success as an Accounting professional. Effective oral communication is the exchange of information critical to influencing others, working in groups, getting along with colleagues, and managing organizational politics. As an Accounting professional, your prospective employer and colleagues will depend on you to effectively describe and explain thoughts, opinions, perspectives, updates, data and statistics.

This course is designed to prepare you for job-related communication tasks. You will learn how to think purposefully, creatively, and critically about your one-on-one and group communications, such as when presenting in formal meetings, speaking informally with co-workers, or communicating remotely online. When communicating orally, you will learn to take the recipient(s) of your message into account. While oral communication styles can vary and be subjective, you will learn basic principles to build your capabilities when speaking about Accounting and Finance-related topics.

The course consists of lectures and in-class activities that build upon required reading, group discussions, individual speaking assignments, and team projects. The learning process will involve implementing communication concepts, ideas, strategies, and practical approaches between and during class – meaning you will be orally communicating within your teams and during most class sessions, and you will use constructive feedback to learn, improve, and develop. In addition, you will be asked to reflect on your own and others' communication processes by learning how to question assumptions, guard against preconceptions, explore, explain, analyze, develop, and critique ideas effectively, and make appropriate decisions about argument, structure and rhetorical conventions.

OBJECTIVES

References to the "audience" or "recipient" apply to various Accounting profession-related groups, stakeholders, and cultures. This course aims to provide the skills and knowledge for you to be able to:

1. **Demonstrate** clear, confident, and professional oral communication in formal and informal Accounting-related interactions, reflecting an understanding of different audiences.
2. **Persuade** audiences orally using sound arguments based on facts and reliable evidence, insightful research queries, and identifying assumptions.
3. **Apply** effective interpersonal and digital communication strategies in team collaborations and Accounting client interactions.
4. **Receive** feedback non-defensively and provide constructive feedback with your peers to foster a continuous learning environment.
5. **Use** observational skills to discern your own and others' communication styles and nonverbal behavior to adapt interpersonal strategies to different audiences and enhance interactions.
6. **Identify** and **leverage** your communication strengths and develop areas needing improvement.

POLICIES

Guiding Principles

By participating in this course, students agree to abide by the following:

1. Promote an environment conducive to learning.
2. If you don't understand something, ask about it; others will likely have similar questions.
3. Show respect and be patient with differences of culture, nationality, values, opinion, and style.
4. Welcome constructive disagreement and respectful debate; this will provide opportunities to learn.
5. Seek to understand with genuine interest first before seeking to be understood.
6. Encourage participation and recognize that everyone has something to contribute.
7. Promote clear communication—be specific, give examples, and ask questions.
8. Speak for yourself. Use “I” statements. Let others speak for themselves.
9. Build on previous comments while being conscious of time.
10. Listen actively without interrupting others to ensure full understanding of communicated messages.
11. Pay attention to class lectures and student comments by silencing and putting away cell phones.

Career Connections at UCSD Rady

The UCSD Rady School Graduate Career Management Center offers individualized attention and guidance for Rady graduate students as they navigate the path to professional success. The Center provides a support network to help you define your career goals, evaluate your strengths, establish professional connections, and pursue your passions. Email the Center at , or call 858-822-7413, or visit <https://rady.ucsd.edu/programs/masters/programs/career-connections/>.

Harassment Prevention

Office for the Prevention of Harassment & Discrimination (OPHD): “Rady students have the right to an educational environment that is free from harassment and discrimination.”

- **OPHD**: (858) 534-8298; ophd@ucsd.edu or <http://ophd.ucsd.edu>
- **CARE** (Sexual Assault Resource Center): (858) 534-5793; sarc@ucsd.edu or <http://care.ucsd.edu>
- **CAPS** (Counseling and Psychological Services): (858) 534-3755 or <http://caps.ucsd.edu>.

Writing Assistance at Rady

The Writing Hub at UCSD offers “...writing support for undergraduate students, graduate students, and faculty—fully online.” For more information, visit the website: Or contact someone at The Writing Hub via email at or via phone at 858-246-5505.

Academic Integrity and Plagiarism

The integrity of scholarship is essential for an academic community. As members of the Rady School, we pledge to uphold the highest ethical standards. The University expects that both faculty and students will honor this principle and, in so doing, protect the validity of the University's intellectual work. For students, this means that *all academic work will be done by the individual to whom it is assigned, without unauthorized aid of any kind, including the use of Artificial Intelligence*. The complete UCSD Policy on Integrity of Scholarship can be viewed at <http://senate.ucsd.edu/Operating-Procedures/Senate-Manual/Appendices/2>. Specifically, because plagiarism is the use and misrepresentation of another person's or Artificial Intelligence's ideas, inventions, writings, images, etc. as one's own, the UCSD Policy on Integrity of Scholarship Appendix 2 is “No student shall plagiarize or copy the work of another person and submit it as his or her own work.”

POLICIES (CONTINUED)

Class Participation (15% of the Final Grade)

Each course session is designed to be interactive. Students are expected to complete all assignments and be prepared to participate in class discussions and exercises actively. Class participation will be graded holistically on attendance, contribution, and engagement at the Professor's discretion and with the assistance of the T.A. Assessment of participation will include evaluating the quantity and quality of students' contributions to class discussions and group exercises. To ensure all students have the opportunity to participate in class, students may be called upon to speak at random. Please let the Professor or T.A. know if you are not getting a chance to speak often enough. The following rubric provides a guide on how your course participation will be assessed.

Active Participation	Moderate Participation	Low Participation
Exhibits evidence of having completed all assigned assignments and activities.	Attempts to participate and has completed most assignments and activities.	Exhibits lack of preparation and noncompletion of required assignments.
Initiates discussion and supports points using page references from readings or other materials.	Supports points during discussion but uses general references to readings and other materials.	Rarely initiates discussion and is not able to reference required readings or other materials.
Furtheres discussions and builds on the ideas of others; comments and questions reflect deep thoughts about the material.	Furtheres the discussion and builds on the ideas of others; general or limited references to course materials.	Comments do not further the discussion and do not exhibit careful reflection on the material.

Attendance

Your attendance and active participation is expected in each class and is factored into your final participation grade. Absences must be pre-approved by the Professor and will only be granted for illness, injury, personal or family emergencies, or religious holidays (for observant students) with at least 24 hours' notice. In these cases, classes will be automatically recorded s and placed on Panopto via the course Canvas Page.

No more than one excused absence will be permitted without impacting your final grade. Absences without pressing, pre-approved reasons will indicate disinterest and result in the loss of all participation points for that class, negatively impacting the final grade. Due to the course's active learning approach, makeup assignments for graded learning exercises completed during class will not be feasible.

Respectful Learning Environment

This course aims to build every student's confidence in public speaking. Many people fear speaking in front of others, especially those with limited experience. Since this class requires active contribution and presentation, establishing a supportive environment where everyone can practice and grow is essential. We expect each student to show others the same respect and support they would want to receive. This same respect extends to interactions with the Professor and TA, who will likewise treat all students with respect and professionalism. Disrespectful behavior including insulting comments, inattentiveness such as cell phone use, or unsupportive conduct will negatively impact the participation grade.

MATERIALS

REQUIRED READING

BOOKS

- Dhawan, E. (2021). *Digital Body Language: How to Build Trust & Connection No Matter the Distance*. Harper-Collins Publishers.
- Navarro, J. (2008). *What Every BODY is Saying: An Ex-FBI Agent's Guide to Speed-Reading People*. Harper-Collins Publishers.
- Reynolds, G. (2020). *Presentation Zen: Simple Ideas on Presentation Design and Delivery*. (3rd ed.). Pearson Education.

ARTICLES POSTED ON CANVAS

- Camacho, L. (2015). The communication skills Accounting firms desire in new hires. *Journal of Business & Finance Librarianship*, 20(4), 318–329.
- Hattaway, D., & Henson, J. (2013). It can be smart to dumb things down. *Stanford Social Innovation Review*. [http://ssir.org/articles/entry/it can be smart to dumb things down](http://ssir.org/articles/entry/it_can_be_smart_to_dumb_things_down)
- Harvard Law School Program on Negotiation (2019) Business Negotiation Strategies – How to Negotiate Better Business Deals.
- Harvard Negotiation Daily (2023). Negotiation Mistakes - When Fear of Impasse Leads to Bad Deals.
- Harvard Negotiation Daily (2023). Preparation for Negotiation - Get Off on the Right Foot.

VIDEOS

- Harvard Business Review. (2019). Telling Stories with Data in Three Steps (Quick Study). https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=r5_34YnCmMY
- Hettiarachchi, D. (2016). Four essential body language tips from a world champion public speaker. <https://youtu.be/ZK3jSXYBNak?si=50UfvX1rlzw0da9r>
- Lyon, A. (2017). Body Language for Presentations. <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=TmbQFWBvTtY>
- Nemko, M. (2014). How to become a better listener. Psychology Today. <https://www.psychologytoday.com/us/blog/how-to-do-life/201405/how-to-become-a-better-listener>
- Wotapka, D. (2018, June 12). *Increase your EQ and shine in the workplace*. Journal of Accountancy. <https://Professor.journalofaccountancy.com/news/2018/jun/emotional-intelligence-201818533.html>

RECOMMENDED READING AND RESOURCES

Oral Communication and Presentation Skills

- Damodaran, A. (2017). *Narrative and Numbers*. New York: Columbia Business School Publishing.
- Denning, S. (2005). *The leader's guide to storytelling: Mastering the art and discipline of business narrative* (Vol. 269). San Francisco, CA: Jossey-Bass.
- Kross, E. (2021). *Chatter*. New York: Penguin Random House.
- Liu, D. (2023). *Say It This Way: Communicate more effectively in business English by recognizing cultural pitfalls and applying key tactics*.
- Sonkin, P. D. & Johnson, P. (2017). *Pitch the Perfect Investment: The Essential Guide to Winning on Wall Street*. Hoboken, NJ: Wiley Press.
- Ury, William. (1993). *Getting Past No: Negotiating in Difficult Situations*. Bantam Books.

ASSIGNMENTS

You must complete all assignments to pass the course. No exceptions. Assignments due before class (pre-class) will be due no later than the start time of that class. Pre-class assignments not submitted before class will be considered late, will not be graded, and will be recorded as 0%. Individual assignments submitted late due to illness or injury require a valid doctor's note to be graded.

There are two types of assignments, primarily based on your team's project: Individual (**IND**) and Team (**TEAM**) assignments. While some weeks will require an individual assignment, each week you will meet with your project team to develop a presentation of your research using **APPENDIX B** as your guide. Below are four examples of team project topics from previous class teams. While these are no longer available, they provide useful ideas to reference when developing your own project team's topic.

Example 1: Value the stock of one of the following four companies analyzed in the recommended reading, Damodaran, A. (2017) *Narrative and Numbers*: Uber; Alibaba; Amazon; or Ferrari. Explain to your audience why the stock is either fairly valued, undervalued or over valued at its current price. (Use the most recent price available and state the stock price and date in the report and in the presentation.) Start with the data provided and update it to the current year. Include a brief description of the company and its business, an overview of the industry in which the company operates, and key fundamental, technical and/or macroeconomic factors supporting your recommendation.

Example 2: Evaluate the effects of increasing interest in Environmental, Social, and Governance (ESG) principles in the accounting or consulting industry. Provide a definition of ESG and describe how ESG is applied in Accounting. Explain to your audience why interest in ESG is rising and whether you believe ESG principles have merit. If so, why? If not, why not? Also describe what effects ESG principles are having on the Accounting industry in terms of benefits, cost, effort and time. Consider whether standards are clear and widely accepted/adopted and the potential implications if they are not. Have any firms or individuals emerged as leaders in this field? If so, why? What are the business opportunities ESG principles create? What business opportunities may be eroding due to ESG? Other topics you may wish to analyze: how firms are communicating their commitment to ESG and whether you believe it is effective; key questions and potential answers firms should be asking and answering around ESG principles; what additional/new areas may emerge given ESG's popularity; whether ESG's popularity will continue or decline.

Example 3: With publicly traded companies holding an increasing amount of goodwill and intangible assets on their balance sheets, what are the implications for the companies, the industry and investors? Why has this increase occurred and is it likely to continue, level off or decline? Has Accounting kept up with this trend? Why or why not? What does the future hold for Accounting for goodwill and intangible assets? Consider addressing the evolution of goodwill/intangible accounting and whether the issue could have/should have been addressed earlier. If so, how? If not, why not?

Example 4: What are the biggest issues companies face in terms of data security? What are the implications—for the company, for the public, for the industry? How can we best address these issues and what are the benefits? What are related costs in terms of time, effort and/or money? How have global standards for data privacy evolved—and have they evolved quickly enough? What are best practices in this area—how long companies keep data, data destruction, data auditing, etc.? Are they sufficient? What new insights can you bring to a client or prospect with regard to this issue?

ASSIGNMENTS (continued)

Overview: IND - Individual Assignments - 65% of the final grade

1. **IND 1:** Oral Presentation Self-Introduction Recording (5%).
2. **IND 2:** Oral Presentation Topic Overview Recording (10%).
3. **IND 3:** Oral Presentation Topic Description Recording (10%).
4. **IND 4:** Oral Presentation Topic Description Practice 1-to-1 during class (15%).
5. **IND 5:** Oral Presentation Self-Reflection Final Recording (25%).

Detailed Descriptions: IND - Individual Assignments

1. IND 1: Oral Presentation Self-Introduction Recording.

Description: Record and post on Canvas a 2-minute video using the guide below.

Guide: Oral Recording.

- a) "My name is...and I prefer to be called..."(nickname if applicable)
- b) (Optional) "My preferred pronouns are..."
- c) "I am originally from...and I now live in..."
- d) "I went to...University...for my Bachelor's degree, and I majored in..."
- e) "I am in the UCSD Rady Master of Accounting program because..."(10 words or less)
- f) "My own communication goals for this class are..."
- g) "My research interest for my Project Team is...because..."

- You may reference **APPENDIX A - ORAL COMMUNICATION PRESENTATION GRADING RUBRIC – INDIVIDUAL AND TEAM** in this syllabus for oral presentation guidelines. This rubric will be used exclusively for feedback on your **IND 1** assignment and not for grading.
- Because this assignment is due early in the quarter, students will start with the maximum grade for this assignment. For each second over 2 minutes, one point will be deducted.

2. IND 2: Oral Presentation Topic Overview Recording.

Description: Record and post on Canvas a 2-minute video describing your Project Team's Research topic using the guide below.

- With your Project Team members, develop two PowerPoint slides, one lead slide, and one content slide to use during your individual recording.
- Record a 2-minute video and post it on Canvas. When sharing your screen to use your slides, ensure your image is approximately 50% of the screen.

Guide: Oral Recording.

- a) "I am a member of Project Team..." (name or number)
- b) "We decided to research...(provide the name of the topic with no more than 10 words)..."
- c) "We find this to be among many interesting and challenging, yet feasible empirical problems to research because..." (list 2-4 reasons relevant to your own Accounting career and career interests).
- d) "The lesson we want to learn is..." (describe one learning goal no more than 10 words).
- e) "Thank you."

Detailed Descriptions: **IND** - Individual Assignments (continued)

2. **IND 2: Oral Presentation Topic Overview Recording (continued)**

Guide: PowerPoint Slides

- a) Lead slide:
 - Project Team name and team member names.
 - Topic title (no more than seven words).
 - Assignment name and due date.
- b) Content slide:
 - Reasons for topic selection (list 2-4 reasons, 4-5 words per reason).
 - Learning goal (list one goal in no more than 10 words).

3. **IND 3: Oral Presentation Topic Description Recording.**

Description: Record and post on Canvas a 3-4-minute video describing your project team's presentation topic in greater detail using the guide below.

With your Project Team...

- Develop a first draft of a PowerPoint presentation that describes your Project Team topic and the research completed so far, integrating your **IND 2** assignment feedback.
- Your research is not expected to be completed at this time, but the outline in your team's slides should reflect a robust beginning to your Project Team's research.
- Complete the first three sections of **APPENDIX B: OUTLINE for the PROJECT TEAM PRESENTATIONS**, (1) Introduction, (2) The Empirical Question, and (3) Data and Methodology.
- Use these three sections to develop and present 7-10 PowerPoint slides, including a lead slide.
- Record a 3-4 minute video using the PowerPoint slides.
- Post the recording with the slides visible on Canvas.

Guide: Oral Recording.

- a) "I am a member of Project Team..." (name or number)
- b) "Our topic is..." (provide the name of the topic with no more than 10 words)..., and this recording reflects what we have learned so far."
- c) "This topic continues to be an interesting and challenging, yet feasible empirical problem to research because..." (Reference the details of the Introduction section from **APPENDIX B**.)
- d) "To set up the problem, the main issue is..." (Reference the details of The Empirical Question section from **APPENDIX B**).
- e) "Our Project Team's data sources and analytical approach are..." (Reference the details of the Data and Methodology section from **APPENDIX B**).
- f) "The way our Project Team will approach the remainder of the project is...(describe additional work needed on sections 1-3 of the outline, and reference the details of sections 4-5, the **Results and Evaluation and Conclusion** from **APPENDIX B**)."
- g) "This is how responsibilities are being fairly divided among our Project Team members..."
- h) "Thank you."

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Detailed Descriptions: **IND** - Individual Assignments (continued)

3. **IND 3: Oral Presentation Topic Description Recording (continued)**

Guide: PowerPoint Slides (Each member of your Project Team will use the same slides).

- a) Lead slide:
 - Project Team name and team member names.
 - Topic title (no more than seven words).
 - Assignment name and due date.
- b) Content slides: (Reference **APPENDIX B** to guide the organization and content of your slides)
 - Introduction
 - The Empirical Question
 - Data and Methodology
 - Project outline.
 - Responsibility division among Project Team members.

4. **IND 4: Oral Presentation Topic Description Practice 1-to-1 during class.**

Description: During class...

- You will practice presenting your project one-on-one with classmates in other Project Teams.
- Time permitting, there will be three opportunities to present to different classmates and obtain constructive feedback from each.
- Your Project Team's PowerPoint slides should be completed and aligned with **APPENDIX B**.
- Each student will have 10 minutes to present and an additional 5 minutes to receive feedback.
- Students will use the **APPENDIX A: ORAL COMMUNICATION PRESENTATION GRADING RUBRIC – INDIVIDUAL AND TEAM** to provide feedback. Students will provide their feedback to each other using this form for future reference individually and for the Project Team. Students will not be graded based on feedback during this assignment.
- Due to the one-on-one nature of this assignment, students will start with the maximum grade for this assignment. For each second over 10 minutes, one point will be deducted.

5. **IND 5: Oral Presentation Self-Reflection Final Recording.**

Description: As the quarter comes to a close, it is essential to reflect on your learning accomplishments and experiences. Record and post to Canvas a 5-7-minute video reflecting on your progress and improvement areas compared to your original goals for the course.

- **Guide:** Reference **APPENDIX A** and **APPENDIX C: IND 5 - ORAL PRESENTATION SELF-REFLECTION RECORDING GUIDE**.

Overview: TEAM - Team Assignments - 35% of the final grade

1. **TEAM 1:** Oral Presentation Topic Description Practice Group-to-Group (10%).
2. **TEAM 2:** Final Team Project Oral Presentation to the Full Class (25%).

Detailed Descriptions: TEAM - Team Assignments

6. TEAM 1: Topic Description Oral Presentation Practice Group-to-Group

Description: During class...

- You and your Project Team will practice presenting your project to other Project Teams.
- There will be two opportunities to present to different Project Teams and obtain constructive feedback from each.
- Your Project Team's PowerPoint slides should be completed and aligned with **APPENDIX B**.
- Each Project Team will have 10 minutes to present and 10 minutes to receive feedback.
- Project Teams will use the **APPENDIX A: ORAL COMMUNICATION PRESENTATION GRADING RUBRIC – INDIVIDUAL AND TEAM** to provide feedback. Project Teams will provide their feedback to each other using this form for future reference individually and for the Project Team. Students will not be graded based on feedback during this assignment.
- Due to the group-to-group nature of this assignment, Project Teams will start with the maximum grade for this assignment. For each second over 10 minutes, one point will be deducted.

7. TEAM 2: Final Team Project Oral Presentation to the Full Class.

Description: During class...

- You and your Project Team present your project to the entire class at the front of the classroom.
- The Professor and students will use the **APPENDIX A: ORAL COMMUNICATION PRESENTATION GRADING RUBRIC – INDIVIDUAL AND TEAM** to provide feedback.
- Student feedback will be expected and considered; however, the Professor will determine the Project Team's grade.
- Your Project Team's PowerPoint slides should be completed and aligned with **APPENDIX B**.
- The timing of each Project Team's presentation will be:
 - 20 minutes to present. One point will be deducted for each second past 20 minutes.
 - 10 minutes for student feedback and Q&A (questions and answers from the audience), and to receive feedback from the Professor.

GRADING

Grading Ranges

Grades will be assigned based on your performance according to the following grade ranges:

A = 93% or +	B+ = 87-89%	B- = 80-82%	C- = 60-67%
A- = 90-92%	B = 83-86%	C = 68-79%	F = 59% or -

Grading Allocation

Your final grade will be based on your performance on the following assignments. The list below is sorted by due date for your planning convenience.

Note: All pre-class assignments are due at 8:00am of the due date.

Due	Timing	Type	Assignment Description	Value
Class 1	Pre-Class	IND 1	Oral Presentation Self-Introduction Recording	5%
Class 2	Pre-Class	IND 2	Oral Presentation Topic Overview Recording	10%
Class 3	Pre-Class	IND 3	Oral Presentation Topic Description Recording	10%
Class 4	In-Class	IND 4	Oral Presentation Topic Description Practice 1-to-1	15%
Class 5	In-Class	TEAM 1	Oral Presentation Topic Description Practice Group-to-Group	10%
Class 6	In-Class	TEAM 2	Final Team Project Oral Presentation	25%
Class 6	Pre-Class	IND 5	Oral Presentation Self-Reflection Final Recording	25%
Total				100%

Video Recording Quality Guidelines

Video assignments must be recorded using your UCSD Zoom account and meet the requirements below.

Quality Standards:

- Ensure you have a reliable internet connection or cell service during your recording.
- Use Zoom's default recording quality (refer to UCSD Rady IT's guidelines).
- Do not record on your cell phone; use a laptop, tablet or desktop computer only.
- Record in a quiet environment with clear audio.
- Sit in a well-lit setting with your entire face, neck, and shoulders clearly visible.
- Practice with Zoom recording at least once before your first assignment.

Recording Process:

- Start recording, then begin with a brief audio/video check.
- When screen sharing presentations, use "Share Screen" and enable "Share computer sound"
- Ensure you remain visible alongside your shared Power Point slides by using Zoom's side-by-side view.
- Stop recording immediately at the end of your presentation.

Submission Requirements:

- Post the Zoom link to the correct assignment submission on Canvas.
 - Include the recording title with your name and assignment.
1. If Zoom fails to record, immediately contact the TA with timestamp documentation.
 2. Keep the video recordings until final grades are posted.

Policy on the Use of Artificial Intelligence (AI) Communication Tools

Core Principles and Course Assignments

Students are expected to complete their preparation independently before using AI or related tools for enhancement. These tools are intended to support the development of communication skills, not to replace them. Students are fully responsible for all presented content and are expected to be transparent about their use of AI or coaching tools.

Course assignments are either in-person or video-recorded presentations. Students are evaluated on presence, delivery, structure, and ability to engage and respond in real time. AI tools are preparation resources; they cannot replicate the skills developed through practice and independent thinking.

Approved Uses

Students may use approved tools for the following purposes:

- Organizing arguments and developing a narrative arc,
- Refining talking points and improving clarity of expression,
- Simulating audience questions and exploring counterarguments,
- Reviewing slide structure and presentation flow, and
- Practicing and improving delivery through dedicated coaching applications.

As the quarter progresses and assignments become increasingly self-directed, students are expected to develop their own topic, angle, and voice. AI tools may support that process but should not drive it.

Prohibited Uses

Students may not use AI or related tools to:

- Generate a verbatim script or deliver AI-authored content as their own,
- Select a topic or develop a core argument on their behalf, and
- Access proprietary course materials.

Approved AI and Presentation Coaching Tools

- ChatGPT (OpenAI) - <https://chat.openai.com>
 - Claude (Anthropic) - <https://claude.ai>
 - Copilot (Microsoft) - <https://copilot.microsoft.com>
 - Gemini (Google) - <https://gemini.google.com>
 - Perplexity: <https://www.perplexity.ai>
-
- Orai - <https://www.orai.com>. AI-powered analysis of filler words, pace, clarity, tone, and confidence, with personalized drills and mock presentation mode.
 - Poised - <https://www.poised.com>. Real-time feedback during virtual meetings to support professional communication.
 - Speeko - <https://www.speeko.co>. Voice, pacing, and delivery development through structured coaching exercises.
 - VirtualSpeech - <https://www.virtualspeech.com>. Immersive virtual environments that simulate real-world settings, including crowd noise and distractions, to build confidence before live audiences.
 - Yoodli - <https://www.yoodli.ai>. AI coaching focused on online meetings and live presentations, providing private feedback on delivery.
 - Additional tools as introduced or recommended during the quarter.

Disclosure Requirement

Students must open each presentation with a brief verbal statement disclosing any AI or tool use in their preparation — for example: *"I used 'Speeko' to work on pacing and pausing"* or *"I used Claude.ai to rehearse responses to counterarguments."* No written documentation is required.

A Note on Authenticity

Effective communication depends on the speaker's credibility, conviction, and presence — qualities that cannot be generated by AI. Students are encouraged to use these tools the way a skilled athlete uses coaching: to arrive better prepared and more confident, while recognizing that performance itself cannot be delegated.

DRAFT

FALL, 2026 SCHEDULE

DATE	TITLE	READINGS DUE	ASSIGNMENTS DUE
Class 1 Nov. 2	Course overview, individual and team assignments.	Read: Camacho, L. (2015); Reynolds, G. (2020). Ch. 1.	Post Pre-Class: IND 1 recording on Canvas.
Class 2 Nov. 9	Communication skills: active listening, empathy, feedback, non-verbal communication.	Read: Reynolds, G.(2020). Ch. 2-4, 5-7 Wotapka, D. (2018, June 12).	Post Pre-Class: IND 2 recording on Canvas.
Class 3 Nov. 16	Communication to influence and negotiate.	Read: Navarro, J. (2008). Ch. 1-2; Dhawan, E. (2021). Ch. 1-3; Harvard Law School Program on Negotiation (2019) Business Negotiation Strategies - How to Negotiate Better Business Deals. Harvard Negotiation Daily (2023). Negotiation Mistakes - When Fear of Impasse Leads to Bad Deals. Harvard Negotiation Daily (2023). Preparation for Negotiation - Get Off on the Right Foot.	Post Pre-Class: IND 3 recording on Canvas.
Class 4 Nov. 23	Public speaking: storytelling for your audience.	Read: Reynolds, G.(2020). Ch. 8-10	Prepare: IND 4 a 1-to-1 presentation using your PPT during class.
Class 5 Nov. 30	Public speaking: Tips, practice, and feedback.	Read: Hattaway, D., & Henson, J. (2013); Reynolds, G. (2020). Ch. 11	Prepare: TEAM 1 Group-Group presentations using your PPT during class.
Class 6 Finals Week Dec. 7	Final Team Project Presentations Self-Reflection: Communication of Learning Goals		Prepare: TEAM 2 Group presentation using your PPT to the full class. Post Pre-Class: IND 5 recording on Canvas.

Note: All pre-class assignments are due at 8:00am of the due date.

CODES	DEFINITION
IND	Individual Assignments you will complete independently.
TEAM	Team Assignments you will complete with your study group.
Ch.	Abbreviation for the word "chapter," as in a book.
Complete	Complete an assignment that does not require writing.
Post Pre-Class	Record or write your individual or team assignment and post it on Canvas.
Prepare	Be ready to present your project topic in class as described in the syllabus.
Read	Read a required article or book chapter, and add any recommended readings.

APPENDIX A: ORAL COMMUNICATION PRESENTATION GRADING RUBRIC – INDIVIDUAL AND TEAM

The following is the Grading Rubric for guidance on how oral communication presentation assignments will be assessed. The grading guide is:

Points Earned	Assignment Value and Grading		
	5%	10%	30%
A = 14-15	5	10	30
B = 12-13	4	8	24
C = 10-11	3	6	18
D = 6-9	2	4	12
F = 0-5	0	0	0

Competency	Criteria				Points
	3 Exceeds Expectations	2 Meets Expectations	1 Below Expectations	0 Unmet Expectations	
1. Relationship to Audience Criteria: Body Language and Eye Contact	Body language and strong eye contact consistently invite a dynamic relationship with the audience.	Frequent eye contact and body language mostly engage the audience.	Minimal eye contact and body language inconsistently engage the audience.	No eye contact or body language, resulting in no engagement with the audience.	
2. Voice Criteria: Volume, Pitch, Tempo, and Clarity	Vocal volume, pitch, tempo, inflections, articulation, and fluid speech consistently express enthusiasm and highlight main points. No difficult-to-understand technical language or provides easy explanations.	Good volume, pitch, tempo, inflections, and articulation, with mostly clear speech and minimal difficult language, usually explained.	Inconsistent volume, pitch, tempo, and articulation. Uses difficult technical language without explanations.	Monotone voice, low volume, no fluidity, and difficult-to-understand language with no explanations.	
3. Organization Criteria: Structure	Highly effective structure with a strong opening, body, and closing. Well-organized with variety supporting the presentation's objectives. Easy for the audience to follow with no confusion. Stays focused throughout.	Effective structure with a good opening, body, and closing. Mostly well-organized with some variety supporting the presentation's objectives. Relatively easy for the audience to follow with minimal confusion. Loses focus no more than once.	Below expectations of an effective structure. Some issues with the opening, body, and closing. Minimal variety, with some support to the presentation's objectives. Somewhat difficult for the audience to follow with some confusion. Loses focus no more than twice.	Insufficient and undeveloped structure. Significant issues with opening, body, and closing. No variety and does not support the presentation's objectives. Difficult for the audience to follow with substantial confusion. Consistently loses focus.	
4. Timing and Pacing Criteria: Speech Speed & Time Management	Pace is consistently appropriate. Completes the presentation within the allotted time and ends on time.	Pace is mostly appropriate. Completes the presentation within the allotted time but ends slightly early or runs slightly overtime.	Pace is sometimes appropriate, occasionally too quick, or slow. Completes the presentation within the allotted time but significantly early or overtime.	Pace is consistently inappropriate. Speaks too quickly or slowly, ending substantially too early or running substantially overtime.	
5. Content Relevancy and Persuasiveness Criteria: Content Quality	Incorporates all relevant information in a persuasive manner. Does not include irrelevant information.	Incorporates most relevant information and is mostly persuasive with minimal irrelevant information.	Inconsistently incorporates relevant information, lacking persuasion, and includes some irrelevant information.	Lacks significant relevant information persuasion, and includes mostly irrelevant information.	
Total	>	>	>	>	

APPENDIX B: OUTLINE for the PROJECT TEAM PRESENTATIONS

1. Introduction

- Explain why this was an interesting and challenging, yet feasible empirical problem.
- Briefly review existing work in this area (if relevant).
- Summarize your Project Team's main findings.
- Provide an outline of any remaining part of your project using the sections below.
- How have the responsibilities been divided among team members?

2. The Empirical Question

- Set up the problem: describe the issue and how your Project Team addressed it.
- Summarize how others addressed the problem from credible research sources.

3. Data and Methodology

- Describe your Project Team's data sources.
- Explain how your Project Team conducted the analysis, including which approaches/tools were used.
- Provide a data description (seasonal/cyclical elements, mixed data frequencies, different sources, etc.)
- Provide a rationale for how your Project Team will best present the results.

4. Results

- Summarize the results and key findings of your Project Team's topic research using visual or graphic representations of the data.
- Explain and justify any refinements in your Project Team's analytical techniques or approach.
- Include at least 3 graphics (charts and/or tables) to support your claims.
- Defend the robustness of your Project Team's results.

5. Evaluation and Conclusion

- Provide your conclusions and properly cite at least 5 research resources specific to the finance or accounting industry to support your conclusions.
- Recommend practical applications of your Project Team's research and results.
- Describe what you and your fellow team members learned from this project.
- Reflect on what surprised you and your fellow team members.
- Describe at least one other area of research that can be done on this topic.

APPENDIX C: IND 5 - ORAL PRESENTATION SELF-REFLECTION RECORDING GUIDE

The following guide is intended to be thought-provoking for your self-reflection process. You may use some or all of the questions below, and use some of your own ideas for this 5-7 minute recording.

Opening

- Introduce yourself and the purpose of this recording.
- State your original oral and written communication goals for the course as you described in your **IND 1** recording assignment.
- Describe in general how this course has influenced your awareness and understanding of professional oral and written communication in the accounting field.

Application of Oral Communication Skills to Formal Presentations

- **Description:** Assess how effectively you believe you applied oral communication techniques in your individual and team assignments.
- **Questions to Consider:**
 - What do you believe were your successes and accomplishments in applying oral communication techniques in your individual and team presentations assignments?
 - What do you believe were your challenges and difficulties in applying oral communication techniques in your individual and team presentations assignments?
 - What is your confidence level when speaking in front groups? How would you compare your current confidence level compared to the beginning of class?

Application of Oral Communication Skills to Informal Interpersonal Relationships

- **Description:** Assess how effectively you believe you applied oral communication techniques in your group discussions to make meaningful connections with your teammates and other students during and between class sessions.
- **Questions to Consider:**
 - What do you believe were your successes and accomplishments in applying oral communication techniques in your interpersonal relationships with fellow students and teammates?
 - What do you believe were your challenges and difficulties in applying oral communication techniques in your interpersonal relationships with fellow students and teammates?
 - What role did you play in the group during Project Team meetings? How did you support the team to complete each assignment successfully?
 - How did you handle group dynamics and any collaboration challenges?
 - How did you manage any disagreements or conflicts within the Project Team?
 - What is your confidence level when speaking with fellow students and teammates? How would you compare your current confidence level compared to the beginning of class?

Application of Written Communication Skills

- **Description:** Assess how effectively you believe you applied written communication techniques in your written assignments.
- **Questions to Consider:**
 - What do you believe were your successes and accomplishments in applying written communication techniques to produce clear, concise, and professional documents, such as emails, reports, and memos?

(continued on the next page)

APPENDIX C: IND 5 - ORAL PRESENTATION SELF-REFLECTION RECORDING GUIDE (continued)

Application of Written Communication Skills (continued)

- **Questions to Consider:** (continued)
 - What do you believe were your challenges and difficulties in applying written communication techniques to produce clear, concise, and professional documents, such as emails, reports, and memos?
 - What is your confidence level in conducting research, properly citing and documenting sources following academic and professional standards, and synthesizing research into your writing? How would you compare your current confidence level compared to the beginning of class?

Professional Growth and Action Planning

- **Description:** Based on your responses to the previous questions, consider how your current communication skills align with your career goals within accounting, and what skills or areas you wish to improve during your Master of Accounting program. Include a concrete plan for continuous improvement and to achieve these goals, including resources, timelines, and benchmarks for success.
- **Questions to Consider:**
 - What specific communication skills have you identified to further grow and improve that are crucial for your accounting career success? What oral and/or written communication skills do you want to develop further?
 - What are your specific goals and action plans to develop your oral and written communication skills?
 - What steps will you take to enhance your oral and written communication skills?
 - What resources or support will you need to remain committed to achieving your professional growth goals? How can the program staff, faculty, and fellow students support your action plans?

Closing

- Conclude with expressions of gratitude, your longer-term career aspirations, and your short-term plans for next quarter.